

Activity 8 - Align Stakeholders, Accountability and Communications

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 5 | Collaborate with Stakeholders Learning outcome: LO5 Duration: 40 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Stakeholder Map, Saliency Model, RACI and Engagement Assessment

Objective

Collaborate with stakeholders and clarify decision rights for execution (A5, K5).

The situation

The POS vendor and Operations each believe the other owns interface acceptance. Finance has not approved a payment milestone, store managers receive conflicting instructions and one influential supervisor resists the pilot.

What you will do

Map influence and saliency, diagnose engagement gaps, clarify RACI, design a two-way communication rhythm and prepare an evidence-based escalation brief.

What you will produce

A stakeholder map, saliency reading, validated RACI, engagement assessment, communication actions and one-minute escalation recommendation.

Tool files in this folder

- [`tools/42 Stakeholder Impact Over Influence Matrix.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/43 Saliency Chart.pptx`](#)
- [`tools/39 RACI Template.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/41 Stakeholder Engagement Assessment Matrix.xlsx`](#)

Step-by-step instructions

1. Identify internal, external, upward, downward and sideward stakeholders.
2. Position stakeholders on impact/influence and justify every high rating with evidence.
3. Apply the saliency lens of power, legitimacy and urgency; compare it with the two-dimensional map.
4. Build RACI rows around deliverables and decisions; enforce one Accountable owner per critical row.
5. Correct missing R/A, duplicated A and excessive consultation patterns.
6. Rate current and desired engagement and define the decision each stakeholder must help shape.
7. Set message, channel, frequency, owner and feedback route for each material gap.
8. Deliver an escalation brief: decision, options, impact of delay, recommendation and deadline.

Evidence to submit

Complete [WORKSHEET.md](#) and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

Critical decisions have one Accountable owner, material engagement gaps have two-way actions and the escalation asks the authorised person for a clear, time-bound decision.

Debrief

- Many communication failures begin as unclear decision rights.
- Engagement is participation and feedback, not message broadcasting.
- Attention follows influence, impact and urgency-not title alone.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 8. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.